

Editorial Team Notes

Your group is responsible for writing and typing all of the front and back matter and back cover copy. Below are templates to guide you through this process. It is also suggested that you look at other books in the library for information and inspiration. Everything that you write and type should be proofread by the proofreading department.

Before you get started, please define the following:

Front Matter: _____

Back Matter: _____

Back Cover copy: _____

Blurb: _____

- *Note:* The “About the School” section can be pulled from existing copy on the school’s website or in the schools promo materials. Ask your teacher where you might find this information if you have difficulty locating it.
- If your book will have sections, you will need an epigraph to start off each section. If your book will not have sections, you will only need one epigraph.

Have fun!

Editorial Checklist

ITEM TO COMPLETE	WHO IS ASSIGNED TO DO THIS?	COMPLETED	PROOFREAD
FRONT MATTER			
Copyright Page			
Table of Contents Page (<i>Production Manager responsible for this</i>)			
Subtitle			
Dedication			
Foreword			
Introduction			
Epigraph(s)			
Acknowledgments			
BACK MATTER			
About the School			
About the Students (<i>Production Manager responsible for this</i>)			
Back Cover			

Proofreading Checklist

When your book is printed, we don't want anyone to find any typos or errors (see, like that one) in the book. It is your group's responsibility to go through the entire manuscript and correct all errors. Please use a red pen. To begin:

- Read Understanding How Grammar Works in Poetry.
- Review the tips below and the Proofreader's Marks and Symbols.
- Make sure the manuscript is numbered.
- *Note:* Other teams are writing new items for the book (e.g., Introduction). Please make sure that you have proofread all new work.

Below are your tasks for the day, in order of priority. Have fun!

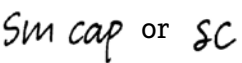
ITEM TO COMPLETE	WHO IS ASSIGNED TO DO THIS?	COMPLETED	ON FLASH DRIVE
Type all new poems			
Proofread all poems			
Proofread other departments' work			
<i>Optional:</i> Input all corrections into the Word file			

Tips and Things to Look For

- Every poem has a title
- All pages, except blank pages, are numbered
- Author names and titles are correct
- No misspelled words
- No missing words
- Each poem has a title, and all titles make sense
- Periods and commas come before quotes
- No extra spaces between words or letters
- All poems make sense

Proofreader's Marks and Symbols

Use the following symbols to indicate your corrections.

SYMBOL	DEFINITION	SAMPLE
 or  or 	delete	take it out
	close up	print as <u>one</u> word
	delete and close up	<u>close</u> up
 or  or 	caret	insert ^{here} <i>(something)</i>
	insert a space	insert [#] there
	space evenly	space ^{eg #}  evenly  where indicated
	let stand	let marked ^{stet} text stand as set
	begin a new paragraph	
	spell out	set <u>5 lbs.</u> as 5 pounds
	set in CAPITALS	set <u>nato</u> as NATO
 or 	set in SMALL CAPITALS	set <u>signal</u> as SIGNAL
	set in lowercase	set South as south
	set in boldface	set <u>important</u> as important
	comma	for example, insert a comma ^{here}
	apostrophe	Kwame's book uses apostrophes
	period	Many sentences end with a period 

Understanding How Grammar Works in Poetry

Do you want to write a **love poem**? Maybe you want to write a **silly poem** for a friend or even a pet? No matter what **type of poetry** you may be interested in writing, **grammar in poetry** is an important concept that deserves to be explored further.

First, understand a **poem** is a compilation of words, but there is so much more than words. There is also how the words are used. Misspelling a word can have as much meaning as the word properly spelled. The same goes for **grammar in poetry**. Simply stated—the normal rules of grammar do not apply in **poetry**.

The **grammar in poetry** depends on the **beat**, the **meter**, and the **rhythm** of your own self. However, you have to show consistency. If you are going to **rhyme**, **rhyme** completely. If you are going to use fragmented sentences, use all fragmented sentences. If you are going to use single words, use single words throughout. If you use some punctuation, use correct punctuation through the whole **poem**.

Consistency in your grammar, no matter the style of grammar you use, will provide a piece of **poetry** easily and smoothly read by your audience.

Grammar in poetry can determine a mood or a feeling. Saying “run” is going to mean more than “he ran.” One is a passive feeling while the other is more an action feeling. If you are going to have a **love poem**, for instance, you may find a smooth pattern will have a more positive response than a jumpy or rough pattern. How you use your grammar will help the **poet** lead the direction of the target audience.

When you get stuck, investigate the benefits of reading other **poets** by visiting **PoetryAmerica.com**. You will discover there are many styles for you to choose from, and no single **poetry** or **poem style** is perfect for everyone or every occasion.

Grammar in poetry is probably as important as the spelling, and as long as there is a consistency, no one usage of grammar can be deemed inappropriate or appropriate. When you write any **poetry**, especially a **romantic poem/poetry**, remember just do what feels right to you. There is no right or wrong in **poetry**, but the smoother a piece of **poetry** sounds, the more likely it will affect the readers.

Production Manager Notes

Your job as production manager(s) is to manage all teams and make sure each completes their tasks.

Note: You will be saving all files from each department on the flash drive, in a folder named after your school. Guard it with your life.

1. Find out who the team leaders are for each task. Explain to them that they will need to type, print everything out for you, as well as save everything on your flash drive.
2. Please research and define the following:

Trim size: _____

Paper color: _____

Paper weight: _____

Cover thickness: _____

ISBN: _____

3. Start collecting bios from each student. See the sample "About the Students" and follow the same format.
4. Generate a Table of Contents (see sample).
5. *Make sure you collect every file on the flash drive and get a printed copy of each department's work. Also, hand everything in to your teacher.*

Production Checklist

ITEM TO COMPLETE	STAFF PERSON	COMPLETED	PROOFREAD	ON FLASH DRIVE
EDITORIAL				
Copyright page				
Subtitle				
Dedication				
Foreword				
Introduction				
Epigraph(s)				
Acknowledgments				
About the school				
Back cover				
MARKETING				
Book party plans				
Media alert for book launch				
Type up name, contact and email of various local media so that we can send the media alert (see example)				
Video				
Coordinate a group photo				
Write blog				

ITEM TO COMPLETE	STAFF PERSON	COMPLETED	PROOFREAD	ON FLASH DRIVE
DESIGN				
Choose cover template				
Look for photos				
Choose title font and color, and placement				
Choose colors				
PROOFREADING				
Type all new poems				
Proofread all poems				
Proofread other departments' work				
PRODUCTION MANAGERS				
Check in with various departments				
Printing spec sheet				
ISBN				
Library of Congress no.				
Order bar code				
About the Students				
Everything on flash drive				

Marketing Checklist

In a few weeks, when your book comes back from the printer, you will have a book party where you read from your book and sign copies for family and friends. In order to get as many people as possible to attend, you'll need to promote this book party. Your group will be in charge of all marketing and promotional aspects of the book party (media alerts, signings, blogs, photography, video, etc.). Please make note of the following:

1. Read the Book Party Form and discuss what you'd like to do for your book party. After you fill in all information, discuss with your teacher to see if the dates and details work for the school.
2. *Remember:* Everything that you write/type today should be proofread by the proofreading department, then put on the production manager's flash drive.

Below are your tasks for the day, in order of priority: *Have fun!*

ITEM TO COMPLETE	WHO IS ASSIGNED TO DO THIS?	COMPLETED	PROOFREAD
Book party plans			
Media alert for book launch			
Type up name, contact, and email of various local media so that you can send the media alert (see example)			
<i>Video blog:</i> students should interview students about the workshop (optional)			
Coordinate a group photo			
Write a blog on the workshop (optional)			
<i>Twitter:</i> One student can periodically post tweets about the workshop			
Do a flyer to promote the book launch			

Book Party Form

Date: _____ Time: _____

(Should be at least two months from now. Please check with your teacher to confirm date and location.)

Location: _____

Open to public or invitation only: _____ Cost or free? _____

How will you let people know about it? _____

Will there be food served? _____

Will this event need funding? If yes, where will it come from?

What will be the program flow? (Use back of this form)

Sample Program

6:05	People arrive
6:15	Welcome by Johnny Rocket
6:17	Opening Remarks by Lenny Penny
6:19	Poets Perform
6:27	Special Guest Musician
6:30	Closing Remarks by Mrs. Obama
6:45	Students Sign Books

Sample Press Release

One School.

Thirty Students.

One Book.

Fifth graders from your school dedicated the fall semester to participating in Kwame Alexander's *Page-to-Stage Writing Workshop*. From start to finish, the students turned their poetry rough drafts into works of art. The library was turned into a publishing house where the cover was designed, the poems were proofread, and the foreword was written, all to produce the book called *I Am*. This book will be released on December 21st from 6:00–7:30 at the school library where poems will be presented, authors will autograph copies, and books will be sold.

For more information, contact:

Teacher, Your School at 555-555-5555 or

Teacher@yourschool.edu

Video Checklist

At your book party, you may want to show a brief video on the workshop. The video will be comprised of interviews with students, teachers, and librarians. The following are your tasks:

1. Decide whether you will shoot your video on a phone, tablet, or with a video camera. Secure the device.
2. Choose a quiet location to conduct interviews.
3. Decide who will record the interviews.
4. Decide who will be the interviewer.
5. Do a test interview before beginning.
6. Make sure everyone projects. **SPEAK LOUD.**
7. The following is the script that the interviewer could use.

Interviewer: Please do not look at camera. Direct all answers to me.

Recorder: Press "Record."

Interviewer: Please say and spell your name for the camera.

Interviewer can choose any or all of the following questions to ask each person:

- *Why do you write?*
- *What did you learn from the Page-to-Stage Writing Workshop?*
- *Do you have a favorite writer or poet? Why is that person your favorite?*
- *What team were you on today?*
- *Can you recite a poem for us today?*

Design Checklist

Your group has the job of choosing the book's interior layout and coming up with a concept for the cover design. Here are some things to keep in mind:

1. Before you begin, please read the Guide to Book Cover Design handout.
2. Please find four books in the library that have covers you really like. Explain to each team member why you chose them.
3. Find out what types of graphics programs (e.g., Microsoft Publisher, Adobe Photoshop, etc.) are on the computers in the school.
4. When you research any photos or illustrations, please use the Image Selection Form to keep track.
5. Feel free to sketch and draw your cover concepts as well.

Below are your tasks for the day, in order of priority. Have fun!

ITEM TO COMPLETE	WHO IS ASSIGNED TO DO THIS?	COMPLETED	ON FLASH DRIVE
Brainstorm cover concepts			
Decide on the size of the book			
Research and select photos for cover			
Sketch and draw art for cover (optional)			
Choose colors for cover			
Choose title font, color, and placement			
Choose font and layout for the book's interior			

Guide to Book Cover Design

Like most people, you probably do judge a book by its cover. If the cover is unattractive, the chances of you buying it are highly unlikely. Deciding on the right colors, photos, and placement of text are all part of the design decision-making process. Who wants to buy the used gray bike in the dusty corner of the store when the brand-new, shiny, red 10-speed hangs in the window (on sale)? The design is the first element of your book that is solely customer-centric. If you build it (and it looks good), they will come.

Graphic design is the general term for artists who use computers to create and manipulate images and text to create some visual product. Whether it is a newspaper ad, letterhead, or a book cover, graphic designers spend endless hours coming up with visual ideas. Software programs that designers typically use include Adobe InDesign, Corel Draw, Adobe Illustrator, and Adobe Photoshop.

Here are some pointers as you embark on this creative journey:

- I highly recommend doing a lot of research! Look at hundreds of covers and book interiors. Find out what you like, and what you don't like.
- Sketch out what you want.
- Become familiar with the elements of good book cover design: color, images, and photographs

Choosing the right look for your cover is a challenging task. It must be a selling tool, so make it distinctive and intriguing to the eye. A cover that has colors will add a multi-dimensional effect, while a cover with black text on white projects nothing. Consider the use of artwork or photography on your cover. Depending on what you discover in your research, one may work better than the other. You can get images for your cover in a variety of ways. Choose a stock photograph or clip art.

RESEARCHING YOUR COVER IMAGES

STEP 1: Search photos related to the theme and title of the book on Google and on stock photo and illustration websites like www.canstockphoto.com/ and www.istockphoto.com/index.php

STEP 2: Type in keywords (related to your topic/theme) to start your search for images.

STEP 3: When you find images you like, there will be a number or file name under the pictures. Write that it down on the image selection form. *Have fun!*

Image Selection Form

WEBSITE	TITLE OF IMAGE	IMAGE ID #

Guide to Interior Design

CHOOSING THE RIGHT FONT FOR YOUR BOOK

Fonts are an important part of your book. They set the mood and can affect the readability of your text. Your book may be great but if someone has trouble reading it due to a bad font choice they may just put it down without finishing or recommending it to a friend.

Below are some of the most common types of fonts and information on where they are suitable for use in your book.

Serif fonts

Serif fonts are fonts that have a little line at the end of each stroke. Some examples are:

Times New Roman
Garamond
Bookman Old Style
Book Antiqua

Serif fonts may be used for every part of your book such as book title, chapter titles, chapter text, table of contents, etc. Serif fonts are the easiest to read large blocks of printed text in and should be the only type of font used for the main body text of your book such as your chapters.

A Word on Times New Roman: Times New Roman was designed for use in newspaper printing presses in 1932 and is not ideal for use in a modern printed book. Consider selecting another serif font for your book.

Sans-serif fonts

Sans-serif fonts do not have a little line at the end of each stroke. Some examples are:

Tahoma
Verdana
Arial
Trebuchet MS

Sans-serif fonts are appropriate for the book title, chapter titles, headers, footers, subheadings, and any short lines of text but should NOT be used for the large blocks of text such as poems, preface, introduction, etc. Sans-serif fonts are not easily readable in printed large blocks of text. This is different than viewing text on a computer monitor. So even if you think your chapter text looks and reads fine in a sans-serif font when viewing on your computer, be aware that the readability will be different when reading it in a printed book form. This has been tested and has been a long-held “rule” for book formatting.

Choosing a Page Layout

The term “page layout” is used simply to describe the way text and images are situated on a page. In order for your book to have a professional look and feel, there are four basic principles to follow.

Contrast

In order for your page layout to be visually appealing and to keep the readers’ interest, you should have contrast on your pages. Use a contrasting font for headings and titles, keep the headings very different from the poem font. Don’t go overboard—use one type for the poems and a different one for the titles. Consider a newspaper and how the headings are larger and bolder.

Alignment

Choose one justification and stick to it. As a rule, center justification will give the page layout a formal look. It is commonly used for wedding invitations, formal announcements, etc. Left justification will give your book a more professional look. Full justification within the layout will give your book a clean orderly look. With full justification, your headings could be either left, right, or centered on the page.

Repetition

Create a sense of unity throughout your book by adding a few visual elements that you like, then repeat them throughout your book. Look through some of your favorite books to see what they have used on the pages; you may get some inspiration. Perhaps a decorative ornament under the heading of each chapter, or a decorative drop cap to start each poem might give your book a special look.

Check this video out: www.mediabistro.com/galleycat/how-to-choose-a-font-for-your-book_b11281#vmix_media_id=10848401

Interior Layout Mini-Lesson

There are two elements of book design: cover and layout. This lesson is concerned with interior layout (also known as page composition). To ensure that our final book looks professional, is readable, and visually stands out, we must produce a creative masterpiece that entices readers.

PURPOSE

In this lesson, you will decide on a design for your poetry book's interior layout.

OBJECTIVES

- To use book publishing to inspire student writing.
- To introduce students to the challenge of page layout; how text and images work together with the page.

RESOURCES

Books (from classroom or library)

LESSON

1. Students should view interior layouts of different poetry books and observe where page breaks occur, where the text is located on the page, and determine what style/size of text is used, and if and how images/art is incorporated.
2. Students should discuss likes and dislikes of various layouts.
3. Students choose layout components for their book by answering the following questions:
 - What are the headers and footers, and where are they located? (e.g., title, page numbering)
 - What is the text font?
 - What is the text point? (e.g., 12 pt)
 - What is the line spacing? (e.g., double-spaced)
 - How is the text aligned? (e.g., left justified)
4. Students should discuss, try different layouts, and ultimately select a layout for the book that is professional and appealing.

Presenting Checklist: Student Self-Evaluation

Always speak with confidence, passion, and conviction. —Kwame Alexander

Name _____ Date _____

Title _____

ELEMENTS	CONSIDERATIONS	REFLECTION
VOICE	• Speaks with a clear, confident voice • Enunciates clearly • Stresses key words for dramatic or humorous affect • Demonstrates strong vocal control, changing voice as needed to emphasize emotions of the piece • Emphasizes rhythm of piece • Pacing is just right; not too fast or slow	
BODY	• Plants feet and stands straight and tall • Relaxed and confident demeanor reflected in strong, steady stance • Manages hands gracefully (behind back, folded in front, at sides) • Aligns gestures with voice to add emphasis • Uses gestures to dramatic effect	
FACE	• Makes eye contact with the audience • Relaxed confidence reflected on face; conveys “true self” • Smiles when appropriate	
PRESENTATION	• Incorporates music, dramatic interpretation, movement, or props into presentation • Demonstrates confidence, passion, and conviction	